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(1) Research Program/Project/Study Title: EXPLORING THE INTERPLAY OF STUDENTS' PERFORMANCE, MENTAL TOUGHNESS, HABITS OF MIND, POSITIVE EDUCATION EXPOSURE, AND EDUCATIONAL READINESS	
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Program or Project has component (if no proceed to 2)? ☐ Yes ☐ No

Component Title:	
Component Leader:	
Academic Rank:	

(2) Category (please check) ☒ Social Science/Education /Humanities & other related fields ☐ Natural/BiologicalSciences ☐ Food Research/ ☐ Developmental/ Computer/Engineering/ Architecture ☐ Extension ☐ Poster	(3) Research Center [Check the concerned center] ☒ SSITRDC Social Science and Industrial Technology Research Development Center ☐ LRDC Livestock Research Development Center ☐ FFRDC Fisheries and Food Research Development Center ☐ CSRDC Crop Science Research Development Center
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(4) Site of implementation			
		Municipality/City:	Pilar
		Province:	Capiz
		Region:	VI
(5) Classification		(6) Mode of Implementation	
Research:	Development:		
☐ Basic	☐ Pilot Testing		
☒ Applied	☐ Tech. Promotion/Commercialization	☐ Single Authorship/Proponent ☒ Collaborative Research (within campus) ☐ Collaborative Research (intercampus) ☐ Collaborative Research (external agency)	
(7) Sector/Commodity		(8) Discipline/Field of Specialization	
EDUCATION		Mathematics/English	

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(9A) Abstract (This has a maximum of 250 words. It contains 1-2 sentences of rationale, followed by objectives, brief methodology, major findings, and implications of impact of the study.)

This study employed a quantitative approach, utilizing a descriptive correlational design to explore the relationships among students' academic performance, mental toughness, habits of mind, exposure to positive education, and educational readiness. The research involved 208 randomly selected first-year college students and utilized validated and reliable instruments for data collection. The findings indicate that students generally exhibit satisfactory academic performance and moderate levels of mental toughness, especially in the aspects of challenge, control, and confidence. They also display various habits of mind, encompassing responsible risk-taking, a commitment to continuous learning, and persistence. Additionally, students have significant exposure to positive education principles, primarily related to well-being and happiness. They are generally well-prepared for educational changes, particularly in self-discipline, digital literacy, and economic capability. The study unveils complex relationships among these variables, emphasizing the role of positive education principles in shaping habits of mind. It also highlights that students with strong positive thinking habits tend to possess greater resilience and mental toughness, enabling them to handle educational challenges more effectively. However, the positive relationship between academic performance and habits of mind is relatively weaker compared to other correlations. This research underscores the potential of educational institutions to not only enhance academic performance but also nurture a deeper sense of purpose and intellectual growth among students. By adopting a holistic approach to education, institutions can cultivate resilient, intellectually grounded individuals who leave a lasting impact on society, extending their influence beyond academic excellence into the very core of a student's character. The findings have substantial implications for educational practices, mental health support, and policy development. Opportunities for future research exist to further expand and deepen our understanding of these critical issues.

(9B) Keywords (Write 3-6 words you used in the study, preferably not found in the title because words in the title are already given keywords. This would also include process, or methodology employed.)

Descriptive-correlational, academic performance, mental toughness, habits of mind, positive education, educational readiness

(10) Introduction (This includes the rationale, background of the study, and objectives which are not divided by subheadings. Incorporate at least three (3) reviews)

The need for research on the interplay of students' performance, mental toughness, habits of mind, positive education exposure, and educational readiness is indisputable. In today's rapidly changing world, students must not only acquire academic knowledge but also develop vital skills and attitudes to navigate the challenges they will face. Neglecting skills-building within college courses leaves students ill-prepared for postsecondary challenges, essentially failing to transfer the skills needed for their future (Vazquez, 2020).

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Moreover, our commitment to diversity in education should be matched by our dedication to preparing students not just for university-level rigor but also for the multifaceted challenges they will encounter beyond academe. Fostering habits of mind and mental toughness, with the principles of positive education, becomes significant. These qualities are not only essential for academic success but also for equipping students to adapt to life's inevitable changes.

Adolescents today face a multitude of complex challenges, from identity consolidation to coping with the impacts of digital technologies and the extended period of adolescence. Navigating these challenges is critical for their healthy development, but many young individuals experience psychological distress or difficulties. A significant proportion faces mental health conditions, including depression and anxiety, yet reluctance to seek professional help is common. Universal prevention strategies are essential to address these challenges and reduce the stigma associated with seeking help (Keyes et al., 2010).

The role of the environment in shaping adolescent responses to key transition milestones cannot be underestimated. The 'stage-environment fit' theory highlights the importance of creating positive environments that allow young people to take control of their development, emphasizing the need for schools to offer opportunities for students to direct their own learning. These transitions in the school environment provide opportunities for students to learn new skills and establish crucial social connections. Empowering students through autonomy, responsibility, and real-world curriculum is essential, as schools play a vital role in enabling adolescents to develop their strengths and reach their full potential (Zarrett & Lerner, 2008).

This research delves into the interplay of students' performance, mental toughness, habits of mind, positive education exposure, and educational readiness is essential to ensure that students are not only academically proficient but also well-prepared to face the dynamic challenges of a rapidly changing world and lead healthy, fulfilling lives. This study is firmly anchored in addressing Sustainable Development Goals No. 3 – Good Health and Well-being and No. 4 - Quality Education, aligning with the Philippines Ambisyon Natin 2040 premise, Region VI Development Plan, and CHED Priority.

An interesting facet of this study is the diverse educational modes experienced by the respondents, spanning the period from pre-pandemic to post-pandemic times now that they are in college. Significantly, this study holds great importance in academe through bridging the gap by investigating the variables influencing student academic performance taking into account their mental toughness, habits of mind, possible exposure to positive education principles, and readiness to any educational set up they may face. The study overcomes the literature gap by incorporating an effective system of reviewing the studies on student performance over the protracted period of the pandemic and not being confined to any time frame. Hence, the study allows future researchers to inflate the scope of the subject.

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(11) Materials and Methods or Methodology (This includes the materials, methods, duration & location of the study. Materials and Methods are headings used in Natural Science researches and methodology is Social Sciences. Presentation of materials may not necessarily be in separate heading but may be incorporated in the specific methods used. Justify paragraphs with main headings in caps.)

Methodology

Research Design

The study is grounded on the objectivist epistemology which holds that meaning, and therefore meaningful reality, exists as such apart from the operation of any consciousness (Crotty, 1998) and that careful research can attain the objective truth and meaning (Esterberg, 2003). This epistemology underpins positivism-- the theoretical perspective which informs the present study. The paradigm of positivism assumes that the social world is inherently knowable and that the people can all agree on the nature of social reality (Esterberg, 2002). Esterberg further advanced that in the tradition of positivism, the goal of social research is to discover a set of causal laws that can be used to predict general patterns of human behavior and so research done in this theoretical perspective, according to Crotty (1998), might select to engage in survey research and employ quantitative method of statistical analysis.

Since this research aims to describe a population through its representative samples, a quantitative research is employed. Furthermore, the descriptive correlational method was employed in this study that aims to estimate the extent of the relationship between two variables. A descriptive correlational design was utilized in this study to describe the level of students academic performance, mental toughness, habits of mind, exposure to positive education, and also to know the relationship between those variables. The descriptive-correlational method is a non-experimental method used to accurately and systematically describe the demographics of the population under study (Creswell, 2012). It focuses on understanding the prevailing conditions and how the respondents function during the study. The descriptive-correlational method determines to accurately and systematically describe the demographics of the population under studied. It emphasized the prevailing conditions on how the respondents of the study function at the time of the study.

The Participants

A total of 208 first year college students participated in the study proportionally representing the six courses offered in a college. Majority of the participants are 19-20 years old (110 or 52.9%), equally representing male (104 or 50.0%) and female students (104 or 50.0%), Roman Catholic (191 or 91.8), single (205 or 98.6), with good health status (145 69.7%). The students are mostly legitimate child (196 or 94.2%), with 2-4 siblings (107 or 51.4), coming from intact family (169 or 81.3) where their mothers (84 or 40.4%) and fathers (54 or 26.0%) are high school graduates, facing unemployment (70 or 33.7%), which has placed them in financially challenging circumstances (142 or 68.3%). Most of the respondents live in coastal areas (67 or 32.2%), taking BSHM (64 or 30.8%), spending 2-3 hours for studying (105 or 50.5%) after school hours, with established study habits (138 or 66.3%), without scholarship

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(191 or 91.8%). Majority are regular (200 or 96.2%) with no work employment (174 or 83.7%) and without stable internet accessibility (115 or 55.3%).

Date Gathering Instruments

The study made use of a number of instruments to gather the data needed to ascertain the extent and relationship of students' academic performance, mental toughness, habits of mind, exposure to positive education, and educational readiness. The instruments had been content validated by psychology, mathematics, and English experts considering the item level content validity index (I-CVI) by Polit et al (2007) and revisions suggested by the experts. The paper adapted four (4) published data-gathering instruments to obtain the data for the study which was subjected to validation with experts and reliability testing.

Students' Academic Performance. The study made use of High School Grade Weighted Average as the students' academic performance of first year students enrolled during the first semester of the school year 2023-24. This was solicited from them in the first part of the questionnaire gathering the data on their socio-demographic profile. The GWA was interpreted using the the Department of Education grading scale: 90 – 100 = outstanding; 85 – 89 = very satisfactory; 80 – 84 = satisfactory; 75 – 79 = fairly satisfactory; and below 75 = did not meet expectations.

Mental Toughness Questionnaire. The study used Mental Toughness Questionnaire-48 (MTQ48; Clough et al, 2002) which is the most utilised instrument to measure Mental Toughness (Gucciardi, Hanton, & Mallett, 2012) for college students. Mental toughness was measured in terms of challenge, commitment, control, and confidence constructs in 48-item 4-point Likert type items. Responses ranged from "Strongly Agree" to Strongly Disagree". It was validated by experts. It was among the comparable nonsample first year college students that determined its administrability and reliability using Cronbach alpha. The instrument proved to be reliable with a reliability coefficient of 0.95. The following scale was used to interpret the means obtained: 3.01-4.00=high; 2.01-3.00=average; and 1.00-2.00=low.

Habits of Mind Inventory. In this study, the Habits of Mind Inventory (2011) of Central and Eastern European Schools Association was used to measure the 16 components of habits of mind, namely: persistence; keeping impulsivity in check; listening with understanding and empathy; thinking flexibly; thinking about thinking; striving for accuracy; questioning and posing problems; applying past knowledge to new circumstances; thinking and communicating with clarity and precision; gathering data through all senses; creating, imagining and innovating; responding with wonderment and awe; taking responsible risks; finding humor; thinking interdependently; and remaining open to continuous learning. The responses ranged from "Always" to "Never" with mean interpretation: 3.26 – 4.00 = primary habit; 2.51 – 3.25 = demonstrated; 1.76 – 2.50 = slightly demonstrated; and 1.00 - 1.75 = not

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demonstrated. Akdeniz (2019) established the reliability of the inventory by Cronbach alpha= .971.

Exposure to Positive Education. The exposure to positive education was measured through the extent of experiences of students on traditional education principles, happiness, and well-being with statements to be rated from “to the very great extent” to “not at all” using the mean interpretation scale: 1.00 - 1.75 not exposed ; 1.76 – 2.50 slightly exposed; 2.51 – 3.25 exposed; 3.26 – 4.00 highly exposed. The Cronbach alpha initially obtained a value of 0.749. After deleting items, an alpha of 0.820 was obtained and signaled the reliability of this instrument to be used for the first year respondents.

Educational Readiness. Educational readiness of students was measured in terms of economic capability, digital literacy, and self-discipline. The responses ranged from “strongly agree” to “strongly disagree” using the mean scale interpretation: 3.26 – 4.00 = highly ready; 2.51 – 3.25= ready; 1.76 – 2.50= slightly ready; and 1.00 - 1.75=not ready. The instrument was found to be reliable with a Cronbach alpha of 0.954.

Data Gathering Procedure

Prior to the conduct of the study, the instrument had undergone validity through the help of experts in the field and reliability testing to students who were not then included as participants of the study. Permission to conduct the study was secured from the satellite director of the college. The instruments were distributed and administered in two rounds. Round 1 is when the researchers officially meet the discuss to the prospective participants the purpose of the study and how students were randomly selected via list which was secured from the registrar’s office. The data on socio-demographic profile and mental toughness were gathered on this round. Round 2, using the same participants, data on habits of mind, exposure to positive education and educational readiness were secured.

To ensure the ethical norms of research, all retrieved questionnaires were secured and coded numerically to maintain confidentiality. Upon the retrieval of the accomplished questionnaires, the data were coded, tallied and interpreted. Frequency count, percentage analysis, mean, and standard deviation were used as descriptive statistics. To assess the normality of the data, the Kolmogorov-Smirnov test was employed, and the results indicated that the data follows a normal distribution. This led to the conclusion that parametric tests are suitable for conducting inferential statistics. The significance level for all analyses was set at 0.05 (alpha level). All statistical computations were carried out using the licensed Statistical Package for the Social Sciences (SPSS), version 29, software.

(12) Results and Discussions (This part contains presentation of results (data) with reference to the table and figure, to be followed by discussion, with support of reviewed literature. Sequence shall be based on the objectives of the study. Tables are formatted without the vertical lines. Horizontal lines are set at the top and bottom portions as well as below table headings and above major subdivisions. Justify paragraphs with main headings in caps.)

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Students' Academic Performance

The study's findings, as presented in Table 2, indicate that a substantial majority of first-year college students achieved very satisfactory academic performance (195 or 93.8%, $M=89.49$, $SD=3.21$), while a smaller proportion excelled with outstanding performance (13 or 6.3%). These findings align with previous research by Salud (2022), which reported that students consistently met the academic standards associated with their chosen tracks and strands, as determined by their K-12 senior high school General Weighted Average (GWA). Although there was a notable decrease in students' academic performance recorded in the study by Osipov et al. (2021), the current educational system has adeptly devised and implemented strategies to address these challenges, effectively transforming them into incentives that mitigate the pandemic's impact on students' academic achievements, as suggested by Li (2022).

The prevalence of very satisfactory academic performance suggests that the educational system, particularly in the transition from high school to college, has been effective in maintaining or even improving students' academic achievements despite the challenges posed by the COVID-19 pandemic. However, the study's findings are specific to the surveyed population, and generalizability to a broader demographic may require further investigation. Future research could delve deeper into the specific strategies and interventions employed by educational institutions that have successfully maintained or improved students' academic performance during challenging periods. Longitudinal studies may also be conducted to assess the long-term effects of these strategies on students' educational journeys. Comparative studies across different educational systems could provide a more comprehensive understanding of effective approaches to addressing pandemic-related disruptions in academic performance.

Students' Mental Toughness

The results showed on Table 3 that students had average mental toughness ($M=2.98$, $SD=0.31$). In details, the students have high regard for challenge ($M=3.11$, $SD=0.39$), control ($M=3.01$, $SD=0.42$), and confidence ($M=3.01$, $SD=0.41$), while maintaining an average toughness for commitment ($M=2.78$, $SD=0.39$).

These findings align with the research of Anselmo and Go (2021), which suggests that Filipino students demonstrate a significant degree of mental toughness. The school may leverage this scientific fact to further develop strategies aimed at enhancing students' mental toughness. This is particularly valuable as it equips students to effectively navigate and persevere through various challenges, hardships, difficulties, distress, and adversities, allowing them to rebound from setbacks and adversities.

The findings suggest that Filipino students possess a foundation of mental toughness, particularly in the domains of challenge, control, and confidence. This existing mental resilience provides an opportunity for educational institutions to build upon these strengths. By developing targeted strategies and interventions to enhance

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commitment-related aspects of mental toughness, schools can empower students to excel in the face of adversity. Furthermore, students with high levels of mental toughness may demonstrate greater resilience and adaptability to the dynamic challenges they encounter.

One limitation of the study could be the generalizability of these findings to a broader population. Additionally, while the study reveals the current state of students' mental toughness, it may not provide insights into the specific strategies or interventions that could be employed to enhance this aspect further. Future research may delve into the specific strategies employed by schools and educators to foster commitment-related aspects of mental toughness in students. Longitudinal studies may help assess the long-term impact of these strategies on students' overall well-being and success. Moreover, comparative research across different regions or cultural contexts could provide a more comprehensive understanding of mental toughness and its development among students.

Students' Exposure to Positive Education

On Table 4, the results showed that students are high exposed to positive education principles when they are attending high school ($M=3.38$, $SD=0.42$). Specifically, they are highly exposed to principles for the development of their well-being ($M=3.42$, $SD=0.44$), happiness ($M=3.38$, $SD=0.51$), and traditional education principles ($M=3.33$, $SD=0.44$).

These results align with the findings of Munwar et al. (2022), emphasizing the school's role as an institution that emphasizes social values and serves as a platform for the transmission of academic activities through socialization. Moreover, the study is supported by Rickard et al. (2023), who indicate that the effectiveness of positive education is contingent upon program delivery and integration into the classroom or extracurricular activities. The impact of positive education principles is also recognized to vary across different developmental stages throughout the school years.

The study's findings underscore the significance of positive education principles in the school environment. High exposure to these principles during high school years suggests that educational institutions are emphasizing students' well-being, happiness, and traditional educational values. This highlights the importance of further integrating these principles into educational settings and curricula to continue promoting students' happiness and well-being. However, the study does not provide insight into the specific practices or strategies that contributed to the observed high exposure to positive education principles.

Future research could delve into the specific strategies employed by schools to effectively deliver and integrate positive education principles. It could also explore the long-term impact of these principles on students' well-being and academic success. Additionally, comparative research across different educational settings or regions may provide valuable insights into the variations in the implementation and impact of positive education principles.

Students' Educational Readiness

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The first year college students are found to be ready ($M=2.93$, $SD=0.50$) for any educational changes they may face as shown on Table 5. This readiness is evident in their willingness to develop self-discipline ($M=3.19$, $SD=0.49$), enhance digital literacy ($M=3.04$, $SD=0.60$), and improve their economic capability ($M=2.58$, $SD=0.72$).

These results contrast with the findings of Reyes and Grajo (2021), who claimed that Filipino students are not adequately prepared for educational changes due to various distractions, such as social media, household responsibilities, family duties, and work obligations. These distractions were found to divert learners' focus away from their academic tasks, leading to decreased productivity. The findings of this study suggest that first-year college students are generally prepared for potential educational changes. Their willingness to enhance self-discipline, digital literacy, and economic capability indicates their positive disposition toward adapting to new challenges in their educational journey. This readiness is essential for students to navigate the evolving educational landscape successfully.

However, the study relies on self-reported measures of readiness, which may not fully capture the nuances of students' preparedness. Thus, future research could delve deeper into the factors that contribute to students' readiness for educational changes, exploring the role of educational interventions, support systems, and personal attributes. Comparative research across different educational levels or institutions may also provide insights into variations in students' preparedness for educational transitions.

Students' Habits of Mind

The findings on Table 6 revealed that the primary habits of mind prevalent among first year college students are taking responsible risks ($M=3.11$, $SD=0.39$, Rank 1), remaining open to continuous learning ($M=3.40$, $SD=0.51$, Rank 2), persistence ($M=3.37$, $SD=0.47$, Rank 3), metacognition ($M=3.33$, $SD=0.49$, Rank 4), striving for accuracy ($M=3.30$, $SD=0.51$, Rank 5), responding with wonderment and awe ($M=3.27$, $SD=0.54$, Rank 6), and listening with understanding and empathy ($M=3.26$, $SD=0.49$, Rank 7). The first year college students also demonstrated applying past knowledge to new situation ($M=3.25$, $SD=0.51$, Rank 8), managing impulse ($M=3.24$, $SD=0.51$, Rank 9), thinking interdependently ($M=3.19$, $SD=0.53$, Rank 10), finding humor ($M=3.16$, $SD=0.52$, Rank 11), gathering data through senses ($M=3.13$, $SD=0.53$, Rank 12), creating, imagining, innovating ($M=3.07$, $SD=0.70$, Rank 13), thinking and communicating with clarity and precision ($M=3.04$, $SD=0.59$, Rank 14), questioning and problem posing ($M=3.01$, $SD=0.53$, Rank 15), and thinking flexibly ($M=2.56$, $SD=0.44$, Rank 16).

These findings are congruent with Lynch (2008) and Javier (2019). The results suggest that when faced with challenges or complex problems, students tend to prioritize taking calculated risks, learning from the outcomes, and persisting through adversity. In contrast, they may be less inclined to engage in flexible thinking, question more deeply, or emphasize communication.

The prevalence of certain habits of mind, such as taking responsible risks and embracing continuous learning, indicates a positive disposition among first-year

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college students. These habits can be valuable assets as they navigate their educational journey. Educators and institutions may consider capitalizing on these strengths when designing curricula and support programs to foster holistic student development. Future research could explore the factors that contribute to the development of specific habits of mind among students, considering both individual and environmental influences.

Correlation of Students' Academic Performance, Mental Toughness, Habits of Mind, Positive Education Exposure, and Educational Readiness

On Table 7, the results of the study revealed that there are positive significant relationships between students' positive education exposure and habits of mind ($r=.738, p=.000$), educational readiness and habits of mind ($r=.659, p=.000$), positive education exposure and educational readiness ($r=.577, p=.000$), habits of mind and mental toughness ($r=.506, p=.000$), positive education exposure and mental toughness ($r=.422, p=.000$), mental toughness and educational readiness ($r=.400, p=.000$), positive education exposure and academic performance ($r=.326, p=.000$), academic performance and habits of mind ($r=.242, p=.000$). There is no significant relationship existing between mental toughness and performance ($r=.117, p=.091$) and the variables educational readiness and academic performance ($r=.116, p=.094$).

There is a highly positive and significant relationship between students' positive education exposure and their habits of mind, indicating that exposure to positive education principles is associated with the development of positive thinking habits. Similarly, a strong positive and significant relationship exists between students' educational readiness and their habits of mind, emphasizing the importance of readiness for adapting to educational changes and the cultivation of constructive thinking habits. The relationship between positive education exposure and educational readiness is also positive and significant, suggesting that exposure to positive education principles can contribute to students' readiness to handle educational transitions and challenges.

There is a moderate, positive, and significant relationship between habits of mind and mental toughness, demonstrating that students with more developed positive thinking habits tend to exhibit greater mental toughness. A positive and significant relationship is observed between positive education exposure and mental toughness, highlighting the potential of positive education principles to contribute to students' mental resilience. The relationship between mental toughness and educational readiness is also positive and significant, suggesting that students with higher mental toughness levels may be better prepared to face educational changes and challenges. Positive education exposure has a positive and significant relationship with academic performance, indicating that students exposed to positive education principles tend to perform better academically. There is a positive, yet weaker, significant relationship between academic performance and habits of mind, suggesting that positive thinking habits may contribute to academic success, but the relationship is less pronounced compared to other variables.

Notably, there is no significant relationship between mental toughness and academic performance, as well as between educational readiness and academic

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performance. Future research may benefit from longitudinal designs to investigate the causal relationships among these variables over time. Furthermore, examining the underlying mechanisms through which positive education exposure impacts habits of mind could provide valuable insights into the educational processes involved. Comparative studies across different educational contexts or populations may also help generalize the findings.

(13) Conclusions and Recommendations (This part shall be written in narrative form and arranged based on the objectives and findings. Conclusions are general statements answering the objectives. Recommendations are based on the conclusions. They may be split or combined based on their length, which means, conclusions and recommendations may be split under separate headings if they are long. Justify paragraphs with main headings in caps.)

This study contributes to the understanding of the complex interplay between academic performance, mental toughness, habits of mind, positive education exposure, and educational readiness. It underscores the necessity of holistic education and encourages academic institutions to prioritize students' psychological well-being and skill development in addition to traditional academics. This research builds upon and supplements prior research regarding student performance, mental resilience, and non-cognitive skills. It advances the existing knowledge base by including the influence of positive education principles and readiness for various educational modes, particularly in the post-pandemic educational landscape.

Educational institutions hold a transformative power, impacting not just academic performance but the essence of learning itself. They can proactively foster intellectual growth, personal development, and a lifelong passion for knowledge. Recognizing that academic performance is not only a research area but also an avenue for enriching students' educational journeys is paramount. Emphasizing commitment and outcome-based learning, educators can craft strategies tailored to students' individual needs, thereby instilling competence and the belief in their capacity to excel and contribute.

The study revealed that students possessed an average level of mental toughness, with particular strengths in challenge, control, and confidence. Educators and institutions can further bolster students' commitment and mental resilience through workshops, counseling services, and mentorship opportunities. By exposing students to diverse challenges, institutions can fortify their mental toughness.

Findings regarding students' high exposure to positive education principles during their high school years underscore the significance of incorporating these principles into the educational environment and curriculum. Encouraging a learning environment that prioritizes students' happiness and well-being is crucial. Policymakers in universities and educational institutions may consider practical policies to integrate positive education principles effectively.

The study indicates that first-year college students generally possess readiness for the educational changes they may encounter. Their willingness to develop self-discipline, enhance digital literacy, and improve their economic capability underscores their positive disposition toward adapting to new challenges in their educational journey. By understanding students' strengths and weaknesses, educators can modify lessons to facilitate learning for all students effectively.

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Students exhibited a diverse range of habits of mind, with several primary strengths. However, some habits, such as thinking flexibly, questioning and problem posing, and thinking and communicating with clarity and precision, appeared to be less emphasized. Educational institutions can design programs and curricula to intentionally promote the development of these underemphasized habits, making them integral to students' learning experiences.

This study unveiled a complex web of interconnected relationships among different aspects of students' educational experiences. It showcased that positive education exposure is closely related to the development of positive habits of mind. Furthermore, the readiness to adapt to educational changes is significantly associated with the cultivation of constructive thinking habits. These findings emphasize the importance of preparedness for academic challenges and the positive impact of positive education principles on students' mental resilience. Notably, students with higher levels of mental toughness are better equipped to handle educational changes and challenges.

While it provides valuable insights, the findings are context-specific to the study's participant pool. Expanding the research to encompass a more diverse range of institutions and geographical regions would offer a broader perspective. Additionally, the study relies primarily on self-reported data, which may introduce response bias. A more comprehensive examination could include objective measures of academic performance and mental toughness.

Future research may delve into the practical implementation of holistic educational models that integrate academic performance, mental toughness, and non-cognitive skills within diverse academic settings. Longitudinal studies could assess the long-term impacts of such models on students' overall development. Moreover, exploring variations across cultures and age groups can offer a deeper understanding of how these interrelated aspects influence students' journeys.

Taking a holistic approach to education transcends the boundaries of conventional academics. It not only imparts knowledge but also instills values such as mental toughness, character development, and the understanding of the interconnectedness of these elements in a student's educational journey. This approach equips students to not only excel academically but also become emotionally and ethically grounded individuals. By adopting this broader perspective, educational institutions contribute to nurturing lifelong learners who face every challenge and opportunity with an unwavering spirit of curiosity, growth, and purpose. This approach leaves a lasting impact extending beyond academic performance, shaping the leaders, thinkers, and contributors of the future.

(14) Output (Indicate the specific products, processes or services which the project has produced; quantify when possible.)

Publication- 1 publishable journal article
Patent/Intellectual Property- BEPLUS Program
Product- BEPLUS Data Management Toolkit
People Services- BEPLUS Workshops
Partnership- BEPLUS Organization
Policy- BEPLUS. BE MORE. BE YOU. Policy

Social Impact

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A positive social impact may be created by improving mental health and well-being and empowering students. A healthier and happier community may be formed through creating the learning environment that nurtures personal growth and academic success.

Economic Impact

It can generate economic impact through a more capable and resilient workforce, innovation, and cost savings in various sectors as a consequence of making use of the results of this study. CapSU human products will exhibit resilience, adaptability and problem-solving skills which will be highly valued by employers. *They exhibit resilience, adaptability, and strong problem-solving skills, which are highly valued by employers. This can lead to a more productive and capable workforce which leads to higher earning potential and economic contributions over lifetimes.*

(15) Technology Transfer Activity Conducted (Indicate the specific products, activity design, processes or services transferred as extension activities)

(16) Economic Analysis (This should present the direct cost of project implementation, expenses in the production of technology, revenues generated from technology produced, return on investment (ROI) and payback period.

(17) Acknowledgments (Include only important persons and institutions with involvement in funding and conduct of the research. Justify paragraphs with main headings in caps.)

(18) References (It should include only works mentioned in the text and should be arranged alphabetically. Citations shall not be less than 13 entries. This must follow the APA latest edition format, in hanging indentation with 12-point space in between.)

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Table 1

Socio-Demographic Profile of the Respondents

Socio-Demographic Profile		Frequency	Percentage
Age			
	18 years old and below	90	43.3
	19-20 years old	110	52.9
	21 years old and above	8	3.8
	<i>Mean Age: 18.9 years old</i>		
Sex			
	Male	104	50.0
	Female	104	50.0
Religion			
	Roman Catholic	191	91.8
	Non-Catholic	17	8.2
Civil Status			
	Single	205	98.6
	Married	2	1.0
	Widowed	1	.5
Health Status			
	Poor (Often Sick)	26	12.5
	Good (Rarely Sick)	145	69.7
	Very Good (Very Rarely Sick)	37	17.8
Birth Status			
	Legitimate	196	94.2
	Illegitimate	12	5.8
Number of Siblings			
	Only child	11	5.3
	2 to 4 siblings	107	51.4
	5 to 7 siblings	62	29.8
	8 siblings or more	28	13.5
Family Structure			
	Intact Parents (parents not separated)	169	81.3
	Disrupted (Parents Separated)	32	15.4
	With one/both absentee parent/s	7	3.4
Mother's Educational Attainment			
	Elementary Undergraduate	21	10.1
	Elementary Graduate	27	13.0
	High School Undergraduate	29	13.9
	High School Graduate	84	40.4
	College Undergraduate	17	8.2
	College Graduate	29	13.9
	Master's Degree Holder	1	.5
Father's Educational Attainment			
	Never entered school	3	1.4
	Elementary Undergraduate	33	15.9
	Elementary Graduate	40	19.2
	High School Undergraduate	28	13.5
	High School Graduate	54	26.0
	College Undergraduate	17	8.2
	College Graduate	32	15.4
	Doctor's Degree Graduate	1	.5

Parents' Employment Status

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Both parents regularly employed	26	12.5
One parent regularly employed	45	21.6
Self-employed (entrep, buy and sell, etc)	24	11.5
One parent occasionally employed	34	16.3
Both parents occasionally employed	9	4.3
Both parents unemployed	70	33.7
Household Composition		
Nuclear (parents and children in the household)	127	61.1
Extended (Parents, children, and relatives)	49	23.6
Single-parent Household	15	7.2
Others	17	8.2
Family Monthly Income		
Rich (at least P182 and up)	5	2.4
High Income (but not rich, between P109,200 to P182,000)	1	.5
Upper Middle Income (between P63, 700 to P109, 200)	5	2.4
Middle Class (P63, 700 to P109, 200)	3	1.4
Lower Middle Class (between P18,200 to P36,400)	7	3.4
Low Income (but not poor, P9,000 to P18,200)	45	21.6
Poor (less than P9,100)	142	68.3
Area of Residence		
Subdivision	21	10.1
Coastal Area	67	32.2
Mountainous Area	55	26.4
Government Housing Project	23	11.1
Others (Along the highway, market place, etc)	42	20.2
Course		
BEEEd	16	7.7
BSA	23	11.1
BSSW	15	7.2
BSBA	48	23.1
BSHM	64	30.8
BSIT	42	20.2
Hours Spent for Studying		
1 hour or less	80	38.5
2-3 hours	105	50.5
4 hours or more	23	11.1
Study Habits		
with established study habits	138	66.3
with no established study habits	70	33.7
Scholarship Status		
with scholarship	17	8.2
without scholarship	191	91.8
Student Status		
Regular	200	96.2
Irregular	8	3.8
Work Status		

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working as university student assistant	4	1.9
work part-time with job outside the university	30	14.4
no work employment	174	83.7
Internet Accessibility		
stable internet accessibility	93	44.7
without stable internet accessibility	115	55.3
TOTAL	208	100.0%

Table 2

Academic Performance of Students

Academic Performance of Students	Frequency	Percentage
Outstanding (90 to 100)	13	6.3
Very Satisfactory (85 to 89)	195	93.8

Scale: 90 – 100 Outstanding; 85 – 89 Very Satisfactory; 80 – 84 Satisfactory; 75 – 79 Fairly Satisfactory; Below 75 Did not meet expectations

Table 3

Mental Toughness of Students

Mental Toughness	SD	M	Description
Challenge	0.39	3.11	High
Commitment	0.39	2.78	Average
Control	0.42	3.01	High
Confidence	0.41	3.01	High
Total	0.31	2.98	Average

Scale: 3.01 – 4.00 High Mental Toughness, 2.01-3.00 Average Mental Toughness, 1.00-2.00 Low Mental Toughness

Table 4

Exposure to Positive Education

Positive Education Principles	SD	M	Description
Traditional Education Principles	0.44	3.33	Highly Exposed
Happiness	0.51	3.38	Highly Exposed
Well-being	0.44	3.42	Highly Exposed
Total	0.42	3.38	Highly Exposed

Scale: 1.00 - 1.75 Not Exposed ; 1.76 – 2.50 Slightly Exposed; 2.51 – 3.25 Exposed; 3.26 – 4.00 Highly Exposed

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Table 5

Students' Educational Readiness

Educational Readiness	SD	M	Description
Economic Capability	0.72	2.58	Ready
Digital Literacy	0.60	3.04	Ready
Self-discipline	0.49	3.19	Ready
Total	0.50	2.93	Ready

Scale: 1.00 - 1.75 Not Ready ; 1.76 – 2.50 Slightly Ready; 2.51 – 3.25 Ready; 3.26 – 4.00 Highly Ready

Table 6

Habits of Mind of Students

Habits of Mind	SD	M	Description	Rank
Taking Responsible Risks	0.60	3.82	Primary Habit	1
Remaining Open to Continuous Learning	0.51	3.40	Primary Habit	2
Persistence	0.47	3.37	Primary Habit	3
Metacognition	0.49	3.33	Primary Habit	4
Striving for Accuracy	0.51	3.30	Primary Habit	5
Responding With Wonderment and Awe	0.54	3.27	Primary Habit	6
Listening with Understanding and Empathy	0.49	3.26	Primary Habit	7
Applying Past Knowledge to New Situation	0.51	3.25	Demonstrated	8
Managing Impulse	0.51	3.24	Demonstrated	9
Thinking Interdependently	0.53	3.19	Demonstrated	10
Finding Humor	0.52	3.16	Demonstrated	11
Gathering Data through Senses	0.53	3.13	Demonstrated	12
Creating, Imagining, Innovating	0.70	3.07	Demonstrated	13
Thinking and Communicating with Clarity and Precision	0.59	3.04	Demonstrated	14
Questioning and Problem Posing	0.53	3.01	Demonstrated	15
Thinking Flexibly	0.44	2.56	Demonstrated	16

Scale: Scale: 1.00 - 1.75 Not Demonstrated ; 1.76 – 2.50 Slightly Demonstrated; 2.51 – 3.25 Demonstrated; 3.26 – 4.00 Primary Habit

Table 7

Correlation of Students' Academic Performance. Mental Toughness, Habits of Mind, Positive Education Exposure, and Educational Readiness

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	<i>Academic Performance</i>	<i>Mental Toughness</i>	<i>Habits of Mind</i>	<i>Exposure to Positive Education</i>	<i>Educational Readiness</i>
Academic Performance	1				
Mental Toughness	.117	1			
<i>p</i>	.091				
Habits of Mind	.242**	.506**	1		
<i>p</i>	.000	.000			
Positive Education	.326**	.422**	.738**	1	
Exposure	.000	.000	.000		
<i>p</i>					
Educational Readiness	.116	.400**	.659**	.577**	1
<i>p</i>	.094	.000	.000	.000	

**Correlation is significant at 0.01 level (2-tailed).